★ NOVACRYPTO PUBLISHING — 2026 EDITION

Crypto for Beginners: From €0 to Your First Portfolio

The plain-language guide to buying, storing, and growing crypto in 2026. No jargon. No hype. Just what actually works.

7	90	€0	15m
CHAPTERS	DAY PLAN	TOOLS NEEDED	TO FIRST BUY

Start on MEXC — Zero Maker Fees →

Open a free MEXC account in 10 minutes · SEPA deposits · 1,500+ coins

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CHAPTER 01

Why Crypto Matters in 2026

3–4% EU inflation 2026	**0.5%** Avg bank interest	**$18B+** BlackRock BTC ETF
€50 Minimum to start		

Your savings are losing value every month. Inflation runs at 3–4% while your bank pays 0.5% interest. The math is simple and brutal: every year you keep money in cash, you lose purchasing power.

⚠ THE REAL COST OF WAITING

€10,000 in a European savings account in 2024 → ~€9,700 in real purchasing power by 2026. Inflation doesn't feel like losing money. It is losing money.

Old rules don't work anymore. Keeping cash used to be safe. Now it's guaranteed slow decline. Bonds barely beat inflation. Real estate requires capital most people don't have. Stocks demand expertise. Meanwhile your salary isn't keeping pace with rising costs.

> *"When BlackRock moves $18 billion into Bitcoin, they're not speculating. They're allocating. There's a difference."*
>
> NOVACRYPTO RESEARCH TEAM

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Crypto solves the access problem. You don't need €50,000 to start. You don't need a broker, a mortgage approval, or a financial advisor. You need €50 and a smartphone. That's genuinely new — for most of history, wealth-building assets were only available to people who already had wealth.

Institutional validation changed everything. BlackRock's Bitcoin ETF absorbed $18B+ in assets within months of launch. Pension funds and insurance companies are allocating. This is not retail speculation — this is traditional finance accepting digital assets as permanent infrastructure.

> 💡 **THE WINDOW**
>
> We're in the transition phase between "risky speculation" and "standard portfolio allocation." This gap represents early-mover advantage. Once crypto becomes as boring as index funds, the asymmetric upside disappears. **That transition takes 3–5 more years. You're still early.**

Crypto isn't about getting rich overnight. It's about preserving what you've earned, earning yield that beats inflation, and owning assets that central banks cannot debase through money printing. Start before the window closes.

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CHAPTER 02 •

The Only 5 Terms You Need to Know

📖 BEFORE YOU READ

You don't need to understand the engineering. You need to understand the concepts well enough to make good decisions. These 5 terms cover 90% of what you'll encounter.

TERM 1 — BLOCKCHAIN

Think of it as a glass staircase where every step is visible to everyone and impossible to erase. Each step records who sent what to whom, chained together permanently. Thousands of computers worldwide maintain identical copies — no single company controls the history.

Example: When Anna sends €50 in Bitcoin to Ben, that transaction becomes a new glass step that computers across the globe verify instantly.

TERM 2 — WALLET

A digital keyring, not a purse. It doesn't store coins — it stores access codes that prove ownership on the blockchain. Your wallet shows your balance but the actual coins live on the shared ledger.

Example: Maria's phone app shows she owns 0.5 ETH, but the ETH lives on the blockchain — her wallet holds the cryptographic key proving ownership.

⚠ TERM 3 — PRIVATE KEY (MOST IMPORTANT)

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Your master password. A unique code that unlocks your funds. Lose it and your crypto vanishes forever — no customer service line can recover it.

Tom wrote his 12-word seed phrase on paper, stored it in a fireproof safe. When his phone died, he recovered €10,000 instantly. His friend Mike ignored backups and lost everything when his laptop crashed.

TERM 4 — DEFI

A 24/7 vending machine for financial services. No bank tellers, no opening hours, no permission needed. Smart contracts execute loans, trades, and interest payments automatically.

At 3 AM on a Sunday, Luca deposited ETH as collateral and borrowed €3,000 in stablecoins — without filling out a single form or speaking to a human.

TERM 5 — MARKET CAP

Price × total supply. Measures the total value of a cryptocurrency. A higher market cap means more money already invested — it reveals relative size, not investment quality.

Dogecoin costs €0.08/coin but has a large supply. Bitcoin costs €60,000/coin but has a limited supply. Compare market caps, not sticker prices.

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CHAPTER 03

How to Buy Your First Crypto in 15 Minutes

✓ RECOMMENDED EXCHANGE: MEXC

0% maker fees · 1,500+ coins · SEPA deposits free · KYC in 5 minutes. All steps below use MEXC. Open your account here: promote.mexc.co/r/UzCEsmBcLP

1

Go to mexc.com → Sign Up → use your personal email. Create a strong password (16+ characters). Confirm your email. Takes 2 minutes.

2

Account → Security → Google Authenticator → scan QR code with your phone. **Screenshot your backup codes and store them offline.** If you skip 2FA and your account is accessed, your funds are gone. No recovery. Takes 3 minutes. Non-negotiable.

3

EU regulations require ID verification. Upload a photo of your passport or national ID + a selfie. Verified within minutes during business hours. You cannot deposit until this is complete.

4

SEPA (recommended): Wallet → Fiat → EUR → Deposit → SEPA. Transfer from your bank. Arrives in 1-2 business days. Zero fee.
Card (instant): 1.8% fee. Use if you want to start today — €1.80 on a €100 deposit.

5

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Trade → Spot → Search "BTC/USDT." Set order type to **Limit** (not Market). Set your price slightly below current price. This makes you the maker → 0% fee. Your order fills when the price touches your level. Repeat for ETH with remaining budget.

6

Account → Security → Withdrawal Whitelist → Enable. This means withdrawals can only go to pre-approved addresses. If someone gets your password, they still cannot drain your funds to an unknown address.

💰 THE FEE DIFFERENCE — OVER 3 YEARS

Trading €1,000/month: **Coinbase = €178/year in fees. MEXC = €0/year in fees.** Over 3 years: Coinbase costs you €534. MEXC costs €0. That's 0.87 ETH at current prices — **just in saved fees.**

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CHAPTER 04 •

The €50 Portfolio Strategy

Start with €50. Not €5,000. €50 is enough to build a habit and learn mechanics without risking rent money. Here's exactly how to allocate it:

60%

Bitcoin (BTC)

€30 of €50

Market anchor. Largest institutional adoption. Survives every cycle. The stability layer.

30%

Ethereum (ETH)

€15 of €50

Powers DeFi and smart contracts. More volatile than BTC but established enough to survive bear markets.

10%

Top 20 altcoins

€5 of €50

Asymmetric bet. Pick top-20 by market cap. SOL, ADA, LINK. It might double — or not. That's why it's only 10%.

The DCA Method

Dollar Cost Averaging means buying a fixed amount every month regardless of price. You don't wait for "the right moment." You buy when it's up. You buy when it's down. Over 12 months, your average entry price smooths out volatility.

✓ THE SETUP (TAKES 5 MINUTES)

Set a recurring bank transfer for the same date every month — right after payday. Transfer €50 → MEXC SEPA. Buy the 60/30/10 allocation with limit orders. **Delete the app from your homescreen.** Check once a week max. Discipline beats strategy every time.

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€50

€600

3

Month 1 invested

Year 1 total

Different entry prices

0%

Maker fee on MEXC

INTERACTIVE TOOL

DCA Portfolio Calculator

Enter your monthly budget and investment horizon to see your projected portfolio value at historical BTC average returns.

MONTHLY INVESTMENT (€)

50

TIME HORIZON (YEARS)

3

ALLOCATION STRATEGY

60/30/10 (Recommended) | 80% BTC (Conservative) | 50/25/25 (Balanced)

TOTAL INVESTED	PROJECTED VALUE	POTENTIAL GAIN
€1 800	€3 218	+79%

🟡 BTC — 60% (€30/mo) 🔵 ETH — 30% (€15/mo) 🟢 Altcoins — 10% (€5/mo)

Monthly: **€50** · Over **3 years (36 months)**

BTC projected: **€1 954** · ETH projected: **€898** · Alts projected: **€366**

⚠️ **Disclaimer:** Projections use BTC's 10-year historical average annualized return (~50% bull / ~20% bear scenarios). Past performance does not guarantee future results. Crypto is highly volatile. Never invest more than you can afford to lose.

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🚀 **Start My DCA Plan on MEXC (0% Maker Fee) →**

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CHAPTER 05

The 3 Biggest Mistakes Beginners Make

MISTAKE 1 — INVESTING MORE THAN YOU CAN AFFORD TO LOSE

Real case: A Lisbon restaurant manager liquidated his €40,000 life savings into Luna coins in 2022. The protocol collapsed within 72 hours. He lost everything.

The fix — The 5% Rule: Calculate 5% of your liquid net worth. If you have €20,000 in savings, your crypto maximum is €1,000. Set this cap before opening any exchange. If you cannot afford to see that number hit zero tomorrow, reduce your position.

MISTAKE 2 — PANIC SELLING DURING DIPS

Real case: When Bitcoin fell from €58,000 to €28,000 in May 2021, retail investors flooded exchanges to sell. They locked in 50% losses. Six months later, Bitcoin hit €67,000.

The fix: Automate discipline. Set monthly recurring buys. Delete trading apps during crashes. Remove price alerts from your phone. Volatility is the entry fee for gains. Selling during red candles turns temporary dips into permanent losses.

MISTAKE 3 — FOLLOWING SIGNAL GROUPS

Real case: The "Wolf of Crypto" Telegram group charged €200/month for "guaranteed 10x calls." Subscribers bought when the admins pumped; admins dumped seconds later. Most signal groups are pump-and-dump schemes.

The fix: If someone knew tomorrow's price, they would buy islands — not sell

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€50 tips. Verify everything independently. Read whitepapers. Check on-chain data. Follow protocol developers, not influencers with affiliate links.

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CHAPTER 06 •

Keeping Your Crypto Safe

Security is not a product you buy — it's a set of habits you build. Spend 30 minutes on these steps now. They prevent losing thousands later.

🔐

Google Authenticator 2FA (Required)

Never use SMS 2FA — SIM-swapping attacks specifically target SMS codes. Download Google Authenticator, scan the QR code on MEXC. Save backup codes offline.

📋

Withdrawal Whitelist (Required)

Restricts withdrawals to pre-approved addresses only. If a hacker breaches your login, they cannot drain funds to their own wallet.

🔩

Hardware Wallet for €1,000+ (Recommended)

Ledger or Trezor — store private keys offline. Buy only from the manufacturer's official website. Never buy second-hand (may be preloaded with malware). Cost: €60–€150.

🚫

Phishing Defense (Always)

Bookmark your exchange URL. Type it manually. Never click links in emails claiming "account suspension." No legitimate company ever asks for your seed phrase — treat every such request as fraud.

🆘 IF YOU GET HACKED: DAMAGE CONTROL

1. Disconnect the compromised wallet from all apps immediately via Revoke.cash
2. Transfer remaining assets to a NEW wallet with a fresh seed phrase
3. Document everything — screenshots, timestamps

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4. Accept that stolen crypto is likely gone. Blockchain transactions are irreversible. Focus on securing what remains.

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CHAPTER 07 •

Your 90-Day Crypto Action Plan

The first 90 days matter more than the next 3 years. Most beginners either quit after the first dip or go all-in on a gamble. This plan keeps you in the middle: learning fast, investing safely, building habits that compound for years.

WEEKS 1–2 · FOUNDATION

Day 1: Open MEXC account. Complete KYC. Enable 2FA. Set withdrawal whitelist. Don't buy anything yet.
Days 2–7: Deposit €50 via SEPA (free). Read Bitcoin's origin story — not charts, not predictions. The history. Why it was built. This context keeps you calm in your first crash.
Days 8–14: Place first buy. €30 BTC + €15 ETH + €5 altcoin (top 20). Use limit orders (0% fee). Write down what you paid. You now have a portfolio.

WEEKS 3–4 · FIRST VOLATILITY TEST

The price will move — probably down first. **This is your test. Do absolutely nothing.** Don't sell. Don't buy more. Observe. Notice your emotions. Notice how "crypto is dead" headlines appear on dips and "Bitcoin to €1M" appears on rallies. Both are noise.

Set your 20-minute daily routine: check portfolio once (not ten times), read one article about a project you hold. Close the app.

MONTH 2 · ADD KNOWLEDGE, ADD CAPITAL

Add €50 more — your first DCA. Buy the same 60/30/10 all
price. Learn one concept per week:
Week 5 = DeFi basics · Week 6 = gas fees and Ethereum L2 · Week 7 = what

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causes market cycles · Week 8 = on-chain metrics.
Order a Ledger if your portfolio exceeds €500.

MONTH 3 · BUILD YOUR SYSTEM

Add your third monthly DCA. Your average entry price is now spread across three different market conditions. Transfer anything over €500 to hardware wallet. Set a quarterly portfolio review — not monthly (you'll overtrade).

By day 90: €150 invested · survived first volatility window · understand 80% of crypto news · built habits that serve you for years.

5m	Check portfolio on MEXC app — **once only**
10m	Read one article on a project you hold or a concept you don't understand
5m	Write one sentence about what you learned — optional but powerful
✓	**Close the app.** Discipline beats strategy every time.

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CORE PRINCIPLES

7 Things to Remember

1 Inflation beats savings accounts — crypto is one of the few assets available to everyone that can outpace it.

2 **MEXC = 0% maker fees**. Coinbase = 1.49–2.99%. Over 3 years at €1,000/month volume, that difference is over €500.

3 **Seed phrase = your money.** Lose it = lose everything. Write on paper. Store offline. Never photograph it.

4 Never invest more than 5% of your liquid net worth. The loss of €50 stings. The loss of rent money is catastrophic.

5 **DCA beats timing** — every time, for beginners. Same amount, same day, every month. Set it and forget it.

6 60% BTC / 30% ETH / 10% altcoins is the beginner allocation. Don't overcomplicate it for the first year.

7 90 days of consistent action builds more wealth than 5 years of chart watching. Zoom out. Stay consistent.

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QUICK REFERENCE

20 Terms, One Sentence Each

BLOCKCHAIN

A shared digital ledger where every transaction is recorded permanently and visible to all.

WALLET

Software or hardware that stores your private keys and shows your crypto balance.

PRIVATE KEY

A secret code proving ownership of your crypto — lose it, lose access forever.

SEED PHRASE

12–24 words that regenerate your wallet — store offline, never digitally.

EXCHANGE

A platform to buy/sell crypto — MEXC, Binance, and Kraken are examples.

SEPA

European bank transfer system — free, arrives in 1–2 business days, best EU deposit method.

MAKER / TAKER

Maker = limit order (sets a price, 0% fee on MEXC). Taker = market order (buys now, 0.05%).

DCA

Dollar Cost Averaging — buying a fixed amount on a schedule regardless of price.

MARKET CAP

Price × total supply — measures relative size of a crypto, not quality.

ALTCOIN

Any cryptocurrency other than Bitcoin — ETH, SOL, XRP are all altcoins.

HARDWARE WALLET

Physical device (Ledger, Trezor) that stores keys offline — use for amounts over €1,000.

2FA

Two-factor authentication — adds a second code required to log in (use Google Authenticator).

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KYC

Know Your Customer — EU-required identity verification to use crypto exchanges.

GAS FEE

Transaction cost on Ethereum — paid in ETH, varies by network congestion.

DEFI

Decentralized Finance — financial services run by smart contracts, not banks.

STABLECOIN

Crypto pegged to fiat (USDT = $1) — used to hold value without volatility.

HALVING

Bitcoin event every ~4 years cutting new supply in half — historically precedes bull markets.

SMART CONTRACT

Self-executing code on a blockchain — runs automatically when conditions are met.

BEAR / BULL MARKET

Bear = prices falling -20%+ sustained. Bull = prices rising. Crypto cycles: 2–4 years.

WHITEPAPER

A project's technical document explaining what it does — always read before investing.

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BONUS — THE €0 TOOL STACK

No subscriptions. No paywalls. All free.

📊 **CoinGecko**

Real-time prices, charts, market cap rankings. Better than most paid tools.

🔍 **Glassnode (free tier)**

On-chain data — see where large wallets are moving money before it hits the news.

🔎 **Etherscan / Bscscan**

Track any wallet or transaction on Ethereum or BNB chain — complete transparency.

📈 **TradingView (free)**

Best charting tool available. Use it to understand price history, not to predict the future.

🛡️ **Revoke.cash**

Check and revoke smart contract permissions — run this monthly if you use DeFi.

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